Learn the Signs. Act Early.

Milestones by 1 Year

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For Everyone

MAY 15, 2026 • ESPAÑOL

WHAT TO KNOW

- Learn about the developmental milestones that most babies do by 1 year of age.
- See important information to share with your doctor.
- Find tips and activities you can do for your 1-year-old.



Ways to monitor milestones

How your child plays, learns, speaks, acts, and moves offers important clues about your child's development. Developmental miles things most children (75% or more) can do by a certain age.

Milestone checklists

Check the milestones your baby has reached by 1 year by completing a checklist, available below and in three additional formats:

- CDC's free *Milestone Tracker* mobile app, for iOS and Android devices
- Web-based Digital Online Checklist
- Printable checklist PDF

Keep in mind

Learn the Signs. Act Early. materials are not a substitute for standardized, validated developmental screening tools.

What most babies do by 1 year

Click the links below to view a photo or video of each milestone.

Social/Emotional Milestones

- Plays games with you, like pat-a-cake

Language/Communication Milestones

- Waves “bye-bye”
- Calls a parent “mama” or “dada” or another special name
- Understands “no” (pauses briefly or stops when you say it)

Cognitive Milestones (learning, thinking, problem-solving)

- Puts something in a container, like a block in a cup
- Looks for things he sees you hide, like a toy under a blanket

Movement/Physical Development Milestones

- Pulls up to stand
- Walks, holding on to furniture
- Drinks from a cup without a lid, as you hold it
- Picks things up between thumb and pointer finger, like small bits of food

SEE ALSO
More about physical development

Share with your child’s doctor

Things to share and consider

- What are some things you and your baby do together?
- What are some things your baby likes to do?
- Is there anything your baby does or does not do that concerns you?
- Has your baby lost any skills he/she once had?
- Does your baby have any special healthcare needs or was he/she born prematurely?

You know your child best. Don't wait. If your child is not meeting one or more milestones, has lost skills he or she once had, or you concerns, act early. Talk with your child's doctor, share your concerns, and ask about developmental screening.

If you or the doctor are still concerned

- Ask for a referral to a specialist who can evaluate your child more; and
- Call your state or territory's early intervention program to find out if your child can get services to help. Learn more and find t at cdc.gov/FindEI.

KEEP READING
Concerned About Your Child's Development?

Tips and activities

What You Can Do for Your 1-year-old



As your baby's first teacher, you can help his or her development.

As your baby's first teacher, you can help his or her learning and brain development. Try these simple tips and activities in a safe w your baby's doctor and teachers if you have questions or for more ideas on how to help your baby's development.

- Teach your baby "wanted behaviors." Show her what to do and use positive words or give her hugs and kisses when she does it. if she pulls your pet's tail, teach her how to pet gently and give her a hug when she does it.
- Talk or sing to your baby about what you're doing. For example, "Mommy is washing your hands" or sing, "This is the way we wa hands."
- Build on what your baby tries to say. If he says "ta," say "Yes, a truck," or if he says "truck," say "Yes, that's a big, blue truck."

More Parenting Tips and Activities

- Redirect your baby quickly and consistently by giving her a toy or moving her if she is getting into things you don't want her
  Save "no" for behaviors that are dangerous. When you say "no," say it firmly. Do not spank, yell, or give her long explanation
- Give your baby safe places to explore. Baby-proof your home. For example, move sharp or breakable things out of reach. Loc
  medicines, chemicals, and cleaning products. Save the Poison Help Line number, 800-222-1222, in all phones.
- Respond with words when your baby points. Babies point to ask for things. For example, say "You want the cup? Here is the
  your cup." If he tries to say "cup," celebrate his attempt.
- Point to interesting things you see, such as a truck, bus, or animals. This will help your baby pay attention to what others are
  him through pointing.
- Limit screen time (TV, tablets, phones, etc.) to video calling with loved ones. Screen time is not recommended for children yo
  2 years of age. Babies learn by talking, playing, and interacting with others.
- Give your baby water, breast milk, or plain milk. You don't need to give your baby juice, but if you do, give 4 ounces or less a
  100% fruit juice. Do not give your baby other sugary beverages, such as fruit drinks, soda, sports drinks, or flavored milks.
- Help your baby get used to foods with different tastes and textures. Foods can be smooth, mashed, or finely chopped. Your b
  not like every food on the first try. Give your baby a chance to try foods again and again.
- Give your baby time to get to know a new caregiver. Bring a favorite toy, stuffed animal, or blanket to help comfort your baby
- Give your baby pots and pans or a small musical instrument like a drum or cymbals. Encourage your baby to make noise.
- Find out about foods that are choking risks. Let your baby practice feeding himself safe foods with his fingers and using a cu
  small amount of water. Sit next to your baby and enjoy mealtime together. Expect spills. Learning is messy and fun!
- Make sure your baby gets enough sleep: 4- to 12-month-olds need 12 to 16 hours of sleep a day (including naps). Consister
  times make it easier!
- "Read" books with your baby. Reading can be talking about pictures. Babies this age like books with things they can feel or f
  can lift.
- Play together with blocks and other toys that encourage your baby to use her hands.
- Babies learn to calm themselves from caregivers who are calm and make them feel safe. Help your baby learn she can calm
  talking softly, holding, rocking, or singing to her. Let her suck on her fingers or a pacifier.
- Let your baby push things around, such as empty boxes, a "kiddie chair," or "push toys," so he can practice walking.
- Encourage your baby to practice walking on her own. Baby walkers are not recommended. Let her hold your hands or hold o
  furniture that is safe.

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National Center on Birth Defects and Developmental Disabilities (NCBDDD)

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